

GENERAL INFORMATION ABOUT THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME

Erasmus+ is the EU Programme in the fields of education, training, youth and sport for the 2021-2027 period. Education, training, youth and sport are key areas that support citizens in their personal and professional development. High quality, inclusive education and training, as well as informal and non-formal learning, ultimately equip young people and participants of all ages with the qualifications and skills needed for their meaningful participation in democratic society, intercultural understanding, and the successful transition to the labour market. Building on the success of the programme in the 2014-2020 period, Erasmus+ strengthens its efforts to increase the number of opportunities offered to even more participants and to a wider range of organisations, focusing on the qualitative impact of the Programme and contributing to more inclusive and cohesive, greener, and digitally fit societies. European citizens need to be better equipped with the knowledge, skills and competences necessary in a dynamically changing society that is increasingly mobile, multicultural and digital. Spending time in another country to study, to learn and to work should become the standard, and the opportunity to learn two other languages in addition to one's mother tongue should be offered to everyone. The Programme is a key component supporting the objectives of the European Education Area, the Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027, the European Union Youth Strategy and the European Union Work Plan for Sport (2024-27). The Programme also strongly supports the Union of Skills initiative and the EU Preparedness Union Strategy. The Programme meaningfully contributes to the Union of Skills initiative by supporting people in developing basic skills, increasing the attractiveness of teaching professions, stimulating entrepreneurship and innovation, supporting cutting edge knowledge and academic excellence, facilitating skill and qualification recognition, enabling labour market integration and bridging Europe's knowledge, skills, and competences gap. EU businesses need to become more competitive through talent and innovation. This investment in knowledge, skills, and competences will benefit individuals, institutions, businesses, organisations, and society as a whole by contributing to sustainable growth and ensuring equity, prosperity, and social inclusion in Europe and beyond. Furthermore, in line with the objectives of the new European Innovation Agenda on supporting talent development for boosting Europe's innovation capacity, developing digital skills and competences and skills in forward-looking fields, such as combating climate change, clean energy, artificial intelligence, robotics, and big data analysis, is essential for Europe's future sustainable growth and cohesion. To increase the qualitative impact of its actions and ensure equal opportunities, the Programme will reach out more and better to people of different ages and from diverse cultural, social and economic backgrounds, with the aim of leaving no one behind. It is at the heart of the Programme to come closer to those with fewer opportunities, including people with disabilities and migrants, as well as European Union citizens living in remote areas or facing socio-economic difficulties. In doing so, the Programme will also encourage its participants, young people in particular, to engage and learn to participate in civic society, raising awareness about European Union common values. In 2026, the Programme will also continue the effort to mitigate the socio-economic and educational consequences of the Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine, including by supporting projects that promote educational activities and facilitate the integration of people fleeing the war in Ukraine into their new learning environments, as well as activities supporting organisations, learners and staff in Ukraine. Another challenge relates to the

Europe-wide trends of limited participation in democratic life and low levels of knowledge and awareness about European matters, as well as their impact on the lives of all European citizens. Many people are reluctant or face difficulties in actively engaging and participating in their communities or in the European Union's political and social life. Strengthening European identity and the participation of young people in democratic processes is of paramount importance for the European Union's future. As the COVID-19 pandemic has shown, access to education is proving to be essential to ensuring swift recovery from crises. This can also be achieved through non-formal learning activities, which aim to enhance the skills and competences of young people and adult learners, as well as their active citizenship. In line with the EU Preparedness Union Strategy, the Programme contributes to enhancing social cohesion and development of social and intercultural competences. It also supports activities focused on critical thinking and digital and media literacy, and thus helps prevent and counter disinformation and fake news. In line with the European Union's priorities in making its economy sustainable, Erasmus+ projects should be designed in an eco-friendly manner and should incorporate green practices in all facets. Organisations and participants involved should have an environment-friendly approach when designing their projects, which will encourage them to discuss and learn about environmental issues, make them think about what can be done to make projects more sustainable on their level, and help them come up with greener ways of implementing their activities. Supporting and facilitating the transnational and international cooperation between organisations in the fields of education, training, youth and sport is essential to empowering people with more key competences, reducing early school leaving, and recognising competences acquired through formal, informal, and non-formal learning. It facilitates the circulation of ideas, the transmission of best practices and expertise, and the development of digital capabilities. This contributes to a high-quality education while strengthening social cohesion. The Erasmus+ Programme is one of the European Union's most visible success stories. It builds on the achievements of more than 35 years of European programmes in the fields of education and training, youth and sport, covering both the intra-European and the international partnerships dimension. The Erasmus+ Programme Guide 2026 constitutes an integral part of the Erasmus+ Call for proposals 2026 (hereinafter the 'Call') and sets out the conditions for participation and funding for the Call. As such, it is based on and subject to the provisions of the Regulation (EU) 2021/817 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 May 2021 establishing Erasmus+: the Union Programme for education, training, youth and sport¹ (hereinafter 'Erasmus+ Regulation') as well as of the 2026 Annual Work Programme of Erasmus+. Actions included in the Call are subject to modifications through the publication of a corrigendum. Potential applicants are invited to regularly consult the Erasmus+ website as well as the Erasmus+ Annual Work Programme and its amendments. Regulation (EU, Euratom) 2024/2509 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 23 September 2024 on the financial rules applicable to the general budget of the Union (recast) (hereinafter 'EU Financial Regulation') applies. The implementation of the Call is also subject to the availability of the appropriations provided for in the draft budget after the adoption of the budget for the year by the EU Budgetary Authority or as provided for in the system of provisional twelfths. ¹<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2021/817/oj/eng>

5 WHAT ARE THE OBJECTIVES OF THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME?

GENERAL OBJECTIVE The general objective of the Programme is to support, through lifelong learning, the educational, professional and personal development of people in education, training, youth and sport in Europe and beyond, thereby contributing to sustainable growth, quality jobs and social cohesion, to driving innovation and to strengthening European identity and active citizenship. As such, the Programme shall be a key instrument for building the European Education Area, supporting the

implementation of the European strategic cooperation in the field of education and training with its underlying sectoral agendas. In addition, it is key in advancing youth policy cooperation under the European Union Youth Strategy 2019-2027 and developing the European dimension in sport.

SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES The Programme has the following specific objectives: • to promote learning mobility of individuals and groups, as well as cooperation, quality, inclusion and equity, excellence, creativity and innovation at the level of organisations and policies in the field of education and training; • to promote non-formal and informal learning mobility and active participation among young people, as well as cooperation, quality, inclusion, creativity and innovation at the level of organisations and policies in the field of youth; • to promote learning mobility of sport staff, as well as cooperation, quality, inclusion, creativity and innovation at the level of sport organisations and sport policies.

6 PRIORITIES OF THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME INCLUSION AND DIVERSITY The Programme seeks to promote equal opportunities and access, inclusion, diversity and fairness across all its actions. Organisations and participants with fewer opportunities themselves are at the heart of these objectives. With this in mind, the programme puts mechanisms and resources at their disposal. When designing their projects and activities, organisations should have an inclusive approach, making them accessible to a diverse range of participants. National Agencies are also vital in supporting projects with a view to be as inclusive and diverse as possible. Based on the overall principles and mechanisms at the European level, National Agencies will draw up inclusion and diversity plans to best address the needs of participants with fewer opportunities and to support the organisations working with these target groups in their national context. At the same time, the SALTO Resource Centres supporting the implementation of the Programme are also key players in promoting and rolling out inclusion and diversity measures, in particular in regard to gathering knowledge and conceiving and running capacity-building activities for National Agency staff and programme beneficiaries. Likewise, the European Education and Culture Executive Agency (EACEA) plays an equally important role for the programme strands that are managed in direct management. In third countries not associated to the Programme, EU Delegations and, where they exist, the National Erasmus+ Offices (NEOs) and Erasmus+ Focal Points are key in bringing the programme closer to the relevant target groups. In order to implement these principles, the Framework on inclusion measures² as well as the Inclusion and Diversity Strategy³ covering all programme fields have been developed to support easier access to funding for a wider range of organisations, and to better reach out to more participants with fewer opportunities. They also set up the space and mechanisms for projects which intend to work on inclusion and diversity-related issues. The Strategy aims to help address the barriers different target groups may face in accessing such opportunities within Europe and beyond. The list of such potential barriers, spelt out below, is not exhaustive and is meant to provide a reference in taking action with a view to increasing accessibility and outreach to people with fewer opportunities. These barriers can hinder their participation, both as stand-alone factors and in combination:

- **Disabilities:** This includes physical, mental, intellectual or sensory impairments which, in interaction with various barriers, may hinder someone's full and effective participation in society on the same footing as others⁴.
- **Health problems:** Barriers may result from health issues including severe illnesses, chronic diseases, or any other physical or mental health-related situation that prevents someone from participating in the programme.
- **Barriers linked to education and training systems:** Individuals struggling to perform in education and training systems for various reasons, early school-leavers, NEETs (people not in education, employment or training) and low skilled adults may face barriers. Although other factors may play a role, these educational difficulties, while possibly linked to personal circumstances, mostly result from educational systems which create structural limitations

and/or do not fully take into account the individual's particular needs. Individuals can also face barriers to participation when the structure of curricula makes it difficult to undertake a learning or training mobility abroad as part of their studies.

- **Cultural differences:** While cultural differences may be perceived as barriers by people from any background, they can particularly affect people with fewer opportunities. Such differences may represent significant barriers to learning in general, all the more for people with a migrant or refugee background – including but not limited to newly-arrived migrants, people belonging to a national or ethnic minority, sign language users, or people with linguistic adaptation and cultural inclusion difficulties. Being exposed to foreign languages and cultural differences

2 Commission Implementing Decision - framework of inclusion measures of Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps 2021-27: <https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/document/commission-decision-framework-inclusion-2021-27>

3 Implementation guidelines - Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps Inclusion and Diversity Strategy: https://ec.europa.eu/programmes/erasmus-plus/resources/implementation-guidelines-erasmus-and-european-solidarity-corps-inclusion-and-diversity_en

4 For more information on this topic, please see the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities: <https://www.un.org/development/desa/disabilities/convention-on-the-rights-of-persons-with-disabilities.html>

7 when taking part in any kind of programme activities may put some individuals off and in a way limit the benefits from their participation. Such cultural differences may even prevent potential participants from applying for support through the programme, thereby representing an entry barrier altogether.
- **Social barriers:** Social adjustment difficulties, such as limited social competences, anti-social or high-risk behaviours; (former) offenders, (former) drug or alcohol abusers, or social marginalisation may represent a barrier. Other social barriers can stem from family circumstances - for instance, being the first in the family to access higher education or being a parent (especially a single parent or parents with young children in lack of wider informal childcare networks), a caregiver, a breadwinner or an orphan, or having lived or currently living in institutional care.
- **Economic barriers:** Economic disadvantage, for instance a low living standard, low income, learners who need to work to support themselves, dependence on the social welfare system, long-term unemployment, precarious situations or poverty, being homeless, in debt or with financial problems, may represent a barrier. Other difficulties may derive from the limited transferability of services (in particular support to people with fewer opportunities) that need to be "mobile" together with the participant when participating in activities away from their place of residence or, all the more, abroad.
- **Barriers linked to discrimination:** Barriers can occur as a result of discrimination linked to gender, age, ethnicity, religion, beliefs, sexual orientation, disability, or intersectional factors (a combination of two or several of the mentioned kinds of discrimination).
- **Geographical barriers:** Living in, for example, remote or rural areas, on small islands or in peripheral/outermost regions⁵, in urban suburbs, in less serviced areas (limited public transport, poor facilities) or less developed areas in third countries may constitute a barrier.

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION To support the successful digital transformation and address societal challenges such as AI or disinformation more effectively Europe needs education, training and youth systems that are fit for the digital age. In line with the strategic priorities of the Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027)⁶ and the two Council Recommendations⁷ adopted in November 2023 on a) the key enabling factors for successful digital education and training, and b) improving the provision of digital skills in education and training, the Erasmus+ programme plays a key role in supporting citizens of all ages in acquiring the digital skills and competences they need to live, learn, work, exercise their rights, be informed, access online services, communicate, critically consume, create and disseminate digital education content. The programme will support the first strategic priority

of the Action Plan, the development of a high-performing digital education ecosystem, by building capacity and critical understanding on how to exploit the opportunities offered by digital technologies for teaching and learning in all types of education and training institutions at all levels and for all sectors, and to develop and implement digital transformation plans for educational institutions. The programme will also support the second strategic priority of the Action Plan by supporting actions aimed at enhancing digital skills and competence development at all levels of society and for everyone (including young people with fewer opportunities, students, job seekers and workers). The focus will be on fostering both basic and advanced digital skills as well as digital literacy, which has become essential for everyday life and for enabling people to participate fully in civil society and democracy. In line with these two strategic priorities of the Action Plan, the European Digital Education Hub⁸ was established to reinforce cooperation on digital education at the EU level and to contribute to exchange of good practices, co-creation⁵ The European Union counts nine outermost regions. These are French Guiana, Guadeloupe, Martinique, Mayotte, Reunion Island and Saint-Martin (France), Azores and Madeira (Portugal), and the Canary Islands (Spain). ⁶European Education Area – Digital Education Action Plan (2021-2027): https://ec.europa.eu/education/education-in-the-eu/digital-education-action-plan_en ⁷ Council Recommendation on the key enabling factors for successful digital education and training: <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-15741-2023-INIT/en/pdf>; Council Recommendation on improving the provision of digital skills and competences in education and training: <https://data.consilium.europa.eu/doc/document/ST-15740-2023-INIT/en/pdf> ⁸<https://education.ec.europa.eu/focus-topics/digital-education/action-plan/european-digital-education-hub> ⁸ and experimentation. The aim of the Hub is to support Member States through closer cross-sectoral cooperation by addressing digital education and training in a lifelong learning perspective. The Hub connects national authorities, the private sector, experts, researchers, education and training providers and civil society through a more agile development of policy and practice in digital education. In order to implement this policy framework through the Programme, a Digital Strategy⁹ covering all programme fields have been designed with the aim to help programme beneficiaries and implementing actors to successfully develop the digital dimension of funded projects. The Programme should reach out to a larger target group both within and beyond the Union by a greater use of information, communication and technology tools, combined use of physical mobility and virtual learning and virtual cooperation. ENVIRONMENT AND FIGHT AGAINST CLIMATE CHANGE Environment and climate action are key priorities for the EU now and in the future. The European Green Deal Communication¹⁰ is the European new growth strategy recognising the key role of schools, training institutions and universities in engaging with pupils, parents, and the wider community on the changes needed for a successful transition to climate neutrality by 2050. In addition, the Council Recommendation on learning for the green transition¹¹ emphasizes the need to provide learners of all ages with opportunities to find out about the climate crisis and sustainability through both formal and non-formal education, and to make learning for the green transition a priority in education and training policies and programmes. Sustainability should become a part of the entire spectrum of education and training, including curricula and professional development for educators, as well as buildings, infrastructure and operations. The Erasmus+ programme is a key instrument for building the knowledge, skills, and attitudes on climate change and supporting sustainable development within the European Union and beyond. In order to implement this policy framework through the Programme, a Strategy on green transition and sustainable development¹² covering all programme fields have been designed with the aim to help programme beneficiaries and implementing actors to successfully develop the green dimension of

funded projects. The Programme will increase the number of mobility opportunities in green forward-looking domains, which foster the development of competences, enhance career prospects and engage participants in strategic areas for sustainable growth, with special attention to rural development (sustainable farming, management of natural resources, soil protection, bio-agriculture). Moreover, Erasmus+, with mobility at its core, should strive for carbon-neutrality by promoting sustainable transport modes and more environmentally responsible behavior. Environment and the fight against climate change is a horizontal priority in selecting projects. Priority will be given to projects aimed at developing competences in various green sectors, including those within the framework of the contribution from education and culture to sustainable development goals, developing green sectoral skills strategies and methodologies and future-oriented curricula, as well as initiatives that support the planned approaches of the participating organisations regarding environmental sustainability. The Programme supports the use of innovative practices to make learners, staff and youth workers true actors of change (e.g., save resources, reduce energy use, waste and carbon footprint, opt for sustainable food and mobility choices).

9 Implementation guidelines - Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps Digital Strategy: https://ec.europa.eu/programmes/erasmus-plus/resources/implementation-guidelines-erasmus-and-european-solidarity-corps-digital_en 10 European Commission – The European Green deal: https://ec.europa.eu/info/strategy/priorities-2019-2024/european-green-deal_en 11 Council recommendation on learning for the green transition and sustainable development: [https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32022H0627\(01\)](https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32022H0627(01)) 12 Implementation guidelines - Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps Green Strategy: https://ec.europa.eu/programmes/erasmus-plus/resources/implementation-guidelines-erasmus-and-european-solidarity-corps-green_en

9 Priority will also be given to projects that – through education, training, youth and sport activities - enable behavioural changes for individual preferences, cultural values, awareness, and more generally support active engagement for sustainable development. Therefore, organisations and participants involved should strive to incorporate green practices in all projects when designing activities, which will encourage them to discuss and learn about environmental issues, to reflect about local actions and to come up with greener ways of implementing their activities. Platforms such as the European School Education Platform (including eTwinning) and EPALE will continue to produce support materials and facilitate the exchange of effective educational practices and policies for environmental sustainability. Erasmus+ is also a powerful instrument to reach out to and engage with a wide spectrum of players in our society (schools, universities, VET providers, youth and sport organisations, NGOs, local and regional authorities, civil society organisations, etc.) who can become active agents in the transition towards climate neutrality by 2050.

PARTICIPATION IN DEMOCRATIC LIFE, COMMON VALUES AND CIVIC ENGAGEMENT The Erasmus+ Programme addresses the challenges and barriers that limit citizens' participation in democratic processes, contributes to their increased awareness and understanding of the European Union and supports them in overcoming the difficulties in actively engaging and participating in their communities and in the Union's political and social life. Strengthening citizens' understanding of the European Union from an early age is crucial for the Union's future. In addition to formal education, non-formal learning can enhance the citizens' understanding of the European Union and foster a sense of belonging. The Programme promotes active citizenship and ethics in lifelong learning by encouraging projects and activities that foster the development of social and intercultural competences, critical thinking and media literacy. Priority is given to projects that offer opportunities for people's participation in democratic life, as well as social and civic engagement, through meaningful formal or non-formal learning experiences. The focus is put on raising awareness of and understanding

the European Union context, notably in regards the common EU values¹³ and the principles of unity and diversity, as well as their social, cultural and historical heritage. In the field of youth, the Youth Participation Strategy¹⁴ has been designed to provide a common framework and support the use of the Programme to foster youth participation in democratic life. The Strategy aims to improve the quality of youth participation in the Programme and complements key EU Youth Policy documents, such as the EU Youth Strategy and the EU Youth Goals¹⁵. The Youth Participation Toolkit¹⁶ accompanies the Strategy and aims to, in practical terms, to provide know-how, recommendations, tools and practical guidance on addressing this horizontal priority with young people and in each of the actions of the Programme. 13 EU values are set out in Article 2 of the Treaty of European Union and briefly defined here:

https://european-union.europa.eu/principles-countries-history/principles-and-values/aims-and-values_en

14 Youth Participation Strategy: <https://participationpool.eu/resource-category/youth-participation/youth-participation-strategy/> 15 European Youth Goals:

https://youth.europa.eu/strategy/european-youth-goals_en 16 Youth Participation Toolkit:

<https://participationpool.eu/toolkit/> 10 IMPORTANT FEATURES OF THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME The following features of the Programme deserve special attention: **RESPECT FOR EU VALUES** The Erasmus+ programme's implementation, and therefore, the programme beneficiaries and the activities implemented under the programme, have to respect the EU values of respect for human dignity, freedom, democracy, equality, the rule of law and respect for human rights, including the rights of persons belonging to minorities, in full compliance with the values and rights enshrined in the EU Treaties and in the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights. In line with the grant agreements, the beneficiary's grant may be terminated or reduced if such provisions are not respected. **PROTECTION, HEALTH AND SAFETY OF PARTICIPANTS** The protection, health and safety of participants involved in the Erasmus+ projects are important principles of the Programme. All participants should have the opportunity to take full advantage of the possibilities for personal and professional development and learning offered through Erasmus+. This should be assured in a safe environment which respects and protects the rights of all persons, their physical and emotional integrity, their mental health and their wellbeing. Each organisation participating in the Programme must have in place effective procedures and arrangements to promote and guarantee the safety, protection and non-discrimination of the participants in their activities. When necessary, adults should accompany underage participants (pupils, VET learners, young people) in mobility activities. Accompanying adults should ensure sufficient quality of the learning component of the mobility as well as the protection and safety of underage participants. In addition, all pupils, students, trainees, apprentices, adult learners, young people and staff involved in mobility activities under all Key Actions of the Erasmus+ Programme must be insured against the risks linked to their participation in these activities. The Programme leaves it up to project organisers to seek the most suitable insurance policy according to the type of project carried out and to the insurance formats available at national level. Furthermore, it is not necessary to subscribe to a project-specific insurance, if the participants are already covered by existing insurance policies of the project organisers. In either case, the following areas must be covered: • wherever relevant, travel insurance (including damage or loss of luggage) • third party liability (including, wherever appropriate, professional indemnity or insurance for responsibility) • accident and serious illness (including permanent or temporary incapacity) • death (including repatriation in case of projects carried out abroad). If applicable, it is strongly recommended that participants in transnational activities are in possession of a European Health Insurance Card. This is a free card that gives access to medically necessary, state-provided healthcare during a temporary stay in any of the 27 EU countries, Iceland, Liechtenstein and

Norway, under the same conditions and at the same cost (free in some countries) as people insured in that country. More information on the card and on how to obtain it is available at <http://ec.europa.eu/social/main.jsp?catId=559>. Finally, if projects involve young people under the age of 18, participating organisations are required to obtain the prior authorisation for participation from their parents or those acting on their behalf.

MULTILINGUALISM Multilingualism is one of the cornerstones of the European project and a powerful symbol of the EU's aspiration to be united in diversity. Foreign languages have a prominent role among the skills that will help equip people better for the 11 labour market and make the most of available opportunities. The EU has set the goal that every citizen should have the opportunity to learn at least two foreign languages from an early age. The promotion of language learning and linguistic diversity is one of the specific objectives of the Programme. The lack of language competences is one of the main barriers to participation in European education, training and youth programmes. The opportunities put in place to offer linguistic support are aimed to make mobility more efficient and effective, to improve learning performance and therefore contribute to the specific objective of the Programme. The programme will offer language learning support to mobility activity participants. This support will mainly be offered via the Erasmus+ Online Language Support (OLS) platform, adapted as necessary to individual sectors, as e-learning offers advantages for language learning in terms of access and flexibility. The Erasmus+ Online Language Support (OLS) will allow participants to assess, practice and improve their knowledge of languages. In addition to OLS, other forms for linguistic support may be offered to support the language learning needs of particular target groups – such as the use of sign language or braille, which can be financed through the dedicated financial inclusion support category. Within the framework of cooperation projects, language teaching and learning will also be encouraged. Innovation and good practices aiming to promote language skills can include, for example, teaching and assessment methods, development of pedagogical material, research, computer assisted language learning and entrepreneurial ventures using foreign languages. The European Commission has established the European Language Label (ELL) awards to recognise quality, to support the sharing of results of excellent projects in the area of multilingualism, and to promote public interest in language learning. National Agencies will award the ELL annually or biennially to education and training organisations that have completed an Erasmus+ project granted by a National Agency with outstanding results in the area of language learning and teaching. In addition to the selection among Erasmus+ projects, the National Agency may decide to award the ELL to other initiatives with comprehensive, inclusive or innovative approaches to the teaching and learning of languages.

INTERNATIONAL DIMENSION Erasmus+ includes a strong international dimension (i.e. cooperation with third countries not associated to the Programme) in mobility, cooperation and policy dialogue activities. It supports European organisations in facing the global challenges brought about by globalisation, climate change and the digital transition, notably through an intensification of international mobility and cooperation with third countries and to strengthen the role of the European Union as a global actor. It enhances societal links through mobility, exchanges and capacity building, nurturing social resilience, human development, employability, active participation and ensuring regular channels for people-to-people cooperation by promoting values, principles and interests around common priorities. Activities offer a response to the challenges of quality, modernisation and employability through an increased relevance and responsiveness of education for a green and sustainable socio-economic recovery, growth and prosperity in third countries not associated to the Programme, contributing to human and institutional development, digital transition, growth and jobs, good governance and peace and security. The engagement of the young people in third countries not

associated to the Programme is a key element in the process of building societies that are more resilient and are based on mutual trust and intercultural understanding. RECOGNITION AND VALIDATION OF SKILLS AND QUALIFICATIONS Erasmus+ supports EU transparency and recognition tools for competences, skills and qualifications – in particular Europass (including European Digital Credentials for Learning), Youthpass, the European Qualifications Framework (EQF), the European Skills, Competences, Qualifications and Occupations classification (ESCO), the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS), the European Quality Assurance Reference Framework (EQAVET), the European Quality Assurance Register (EQAR), the European Association for Quality Assurance in Higher Education (ENQA) – as well as EU wide networks in the field of education and training supporting these tools, in particular the National Academic Recognition Information Centre (NARIC), Euroguidance networks, the National Europass Centres and the EQF National Coordination Points. A common purpose of these tools is to ensure that competences, skills and qualifications can be more easily recognised and are better understood, within and across national borders, in all sub-systems of education 12 and training as well as in all sectors of the labour market, no matter whether these were acquired through formal education and training or through other learning experiences (e.g., work experience; volunteering, online learning). In order to fulfil these objectives, the tools available should be able to cater for new phenomena, such as internationalisation of education and training and growing use of digital learning and digital credentialing, as well as support the creation of flexible learning pathways in line with learners' needs and objectives. The tools should also enhance comparability and portability of skills, competences and qualifications across borders, allowing learners and workers to move freely for learning or working. A number of long-standing policy documents guide the implementation and further development of these tools, including the Council Recommendation of 22 May 2017 on the European Qualifications Framework for lifelong learning, the Decision (EU) 2018/646 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 18 April 2018 on a common framework for the provision of better services for skills and qualifications (Europass) and the Council Recommendation of 20 December 2012 on the validation of non-formal and informal learning. In addition to these horizontal policy documents, thematic strategies such as the Youthpass Strategy¹⁷ and the European Training Strategy (ETS)¹⁸ in the field of youth aim at offering further support to developments in these areas. COMMUNICATING PROJECTS AND THEIR RESULTS TO MAXIMISE IMPACT Communicating projects and their results is crucial to ensure impact on different levels. Depending on the action, applicants for funding under Erasmus+ are required to plan their communication activities aimed at sharing information about their project and results during and beyond the project life cycle. Project applications will be evaluated based on relevant criteria to ensure that these aspects are covered. The level and intensity of communication and dissemination activities should be proportional to the objectives, the scope and the targets of the different actions of Erasmus+. Beneficiaries of Erasmus+ funding must follow the communication guidelines for project beneficiaries¹⁹ prepared by the European Commission, and monitor and evaluate the success of their communication activities, both qualitatively and quantitatively. As indicated in the communication guidelines, beneficiaries must clearly acknowledge the European Union's support in all communication and dissemination activities and products, such as events, websites, visual material, and publications. In particular, they must ensure that the European Union emblem is included in all communication materials and that it respects the provisions laid out in the grant agreement or grant decision²⁰. The beneficiary's grant may be reduced if such provisions are not respected. Beneficiaries shall design a communication strategy and a communication plan by taking into consideration the following factors. • The communication objectives: Applicants should identify what they would like to achieve with specific

communication activities, i.e., to raise awareness, promote societal values, develop new partnerships for the future or influence policies and practices. • The audience or target group: Applicants need to define the people they would like to reach out to and that could make use of project results. The audience or target group should be defined as specifically as possible. It can be the general public, specific stakeholders, experts and other interested parties, decision-makers, media etc. • The channels and activities to reach the target audience: applicants need to choose the channels and activities that are the most effective and appropriate to meet the needs of their chosen targets, such as social media, events, publications. • The project results (outputs and outcomes) such as a good practice guide, a practical tool or product, research report of study, what knowledge and skills were gained and so on. Results should also be shared or promoted via the 17 Youthpass Strategy: <https://www.youthpass.eu/en/about-youthpass/youthpass-strategy/> 18 European Training Strategy (ETS): <https://europeantrainingstrategy.eu/> 19 How to communicate your project: <https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/429c34ff-7231-11ec-913601aa75ed71a1/language-en/format-PDF/source-248841143> 20 Guidance on how to use the European Commission visual identity, including the European Union emblem, can be found at https://ec.europa.eu/info/resources-partners/european-commission-visual-identity_en#documents and https://commission.europa.eu/system/files/2021-05/eu-emblem-rules_en.pdf 13 Erasmus+ Project Result Platform (https://ec.europa.eu/programmes/erasmus-plus/projects_en). • The timing: Applicants need to effectively plan when different activities take place (linking it to work plan/ milestones), agree on realistic targets and ensure flexibility depending on the project progress, the change in needs of the target audience or group as well as development in policy and procedure. • Key performance indicators (KPIs): Performance indicators are a valuable management tool in monitoring progress (and allowing adjustments if needed) during the implementation of the communication and dissemination activities as well as evaluating the degree of success in achieving their objectives. KPIs should be consistent with the corporate Communication Network Indicators²¹. ERASMUS+ OPEN ACCESS REQUIREMENT FOR EDUCATIONAL MATERIALS Erasmus+ promotes open access to project outputs to support learning, teaching, training, and youth work. In particular, Erasmus+ beneficiaries are obliged to make any educational resources and tools which are produced in the context of projects supported by the Programme – documents, media, software or other materials - freely available to the public under an open license. The materials should be easily accessible and retrievable without cost or limitations, and the open license must allow the public to use, reuse, adapt and share the resource. Such materials are known as ‘Open Educational Resources’ (OER). To achieve this aim, the resources should be uploaded in an editable digital form and on a suitable and openly accessible platform. While Erasmus+ encourages beneficiaries to apply the most open licenses²², beneficiaries may choose licenses that impose some limitations, e.g. restrict commercial use by others, or commit others to apply the same license on derivative works, provided that this is appropriate to the nature of the project and to the type of material in question, and that it still allows the public to use, reuse, adapt and share the resource. The open access requirement is obligatory and is without prejudice to the intellectual property rights of the grant beneficiaries. ERASMUS+ OPEN ACCESS FOR RESEARCH AND DATA Erasmus+ encourages beneficiaries to publish research outputs through open access pathways, i.e., in ways which are free of cost or other access restrictions for users. Beneficiaries are also encouraged to apply open licenses to research outputs. Whenever possible, data collected through projects should be published as 'open data', i.e., with an open license, in a suitable format and on a suitable open data platform. 21 Communication Network Indicators and the supporting guide can be found here:

<https://commission.europa.eu/system/files/2023-02/2022%20EC%20Comm%20indicators.pdf> 22 E.g., the widely used Creative Commons Attribution or Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike licenses for creative works, the GNU Public License and GNU Lesser Public License for software, or the Open Database License for databases. 14 WHAT IS THE STRUCTURE OF THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME? In order to achieve its objectives, the Erasmus+ Programme foresees the implementation of the following Key Actions in the 2021-2027 period: KEY ACTION 1 – MOBILITY OF INDIVIDUALS This Key Action supports:

- Mobility of learners and staff: Opportunities for pupils, students, adult learners, trainees and young people, as well as for professors, teachers, trainers, educators, youth workers, sport staff, staff of education institutions and civil society organisations to undertake a learning and/or professional experience in another country.
- Youth participation activities: Youth-led local and transnational initiatives run by informal groups of young people and/or youth organisations to help young people engage and learn to participate in democratic life, raising awareness about European Union common values and fundamental rights, bringing together young people and decision makers at local, national and European level, as well as contributing to European Union common goals.
- Mobility of staff in the field of sport: Staff of sport organisations, primarily in grassroots sports, are provided the opportunity to improve their competences and qualifications and acquire new skills through learning mobilities and spending a period of time abroad, thus contributing to the capacity-building and development of sport organisations. This action supports the professional development of coaches and other staff (both paid staff and volunteers) in grassroots sport. Staff in non-grassroots sport, including those engaged in dual sport and non-sport careers, can also enhance the learning impact and knowledge transfer for grassroots sport staff and organisations. Learning mobility opportunities for staff in non-grassroots sport may be supported where the participation of such staff can benefit grassroots sport.
- DiscoverEU: The action offers 18-year-olds the opportunity to have a short-term individual or group travel experience throughout Europe. As an informal learning activity, DiscoverEU aims at fostering the sense of belonging to the European Union of the participants and allow them to explore its cultural diversity. It also seeks to equip young people with skills and competences of value to their future lives, as well as inspire them to embrace sustainable travel in particular and environmental conscience in general. DiscoverEU includes a general action, where the young people can apply directly on the European Youth Portal, as well as an inclusion action. The DiscoverEU Inclusion Action targets young people with fewer opportunities, aged between 18 and 21, to facilitate their participation in DiscoverEU on equal footing with their peers.
- The programme offers language learning opportunities to participants carrying out a mobility activity abroad. This support will mainly be offered via the Erasmus+ Online Language Support (OLS) tool, adapted as necessary to individual sectors, as e-learning offers advantages for language learning in terms of access and flexibility. In particular cases when online learning is not the best tool to reach the target group, additional forms of language support will be offered.
- Virtual exchanges in higher education and youth: This action gives the opportunity to organise online people-to-people activities that promote intercultural dialogue and soft skills development between individuals from third countries not associated to the programme, EU Member States or third countries associated to the programme. They take place in small groups and are always moderated by a trained facilitator.

KEY ACTION 2 – COOPERATION AMONG ORGANISATIONS AND INSTITUTIONS This Key Action supports: Partnerships for Cooperation, including:

- Cooperation Partnerships: The primary goal of Cooperation Partnerships is to allow organisations to increase the quality and relevance of their activities, to develop and reinforce their networks of partners, to increase their capacity to operate jointly at transnational level, boosting internationalisation of their activities, and through exchanging or developing new

practices and methods as well as sharing and confronting ideas.

- **Small-scale Partnerships:** This action aims to widen access to the programme for small-scale actors and individuals who are hard to reach in the fields of school education, adult education, vocational education and training, youth and sport. With lower grant amounts awarded to organisations, shorter duration and simpler administrative requirements compared to the Cooperation Partnerships, this action aims at reaching out to grassroots organisations, newcomers to the Programme and less experienced organisations, reducing entry barriers to the 15 Programme for organisations with smaller organisational capacity.
- **European Partnerships for School Development:** This action fosters the development of supportive structures that can give a strategic, overarching dimension to the efforts of schools and teachers implementing cooperation and mobility projects on the ground, so that their results can become sustainable and accessible to all.
- **Partnerships for Excellence, including:**
 - **European Universities:** This action supports the emergence of bottom-up alliances of higher education institutions which will bring cross-border cooperation to the next level of ambition through the development of joint long-term strategies for top-quality education, research and innovation based on a common vision and shared values.
 - **Centres of Vocational Excellence (CoVE):** This action supports a bottom-up approach to vocational excellence involving a wide range of local stakeholders enabling VET institutions to rapidly adapt skills provision to evolving economic and social needs. They operate in a given local context, creating skills ecosystems for innovation, regional development, and social inclusion, while working with CoVEs in other countries through international collaborative networks. It provides opportunities for the initial training of young people as well as the continuing up-skilling and re-skilling of adults through a flexible and timely offer of training that meets the needs of a dynamic labour market, including in the context of the green and digital transitions.
 - **Erasmus+ Teacher Academies:** The overall objective of this action is to create European partnerships of teacher education and training providers to set up Erasmus+ Teacher Academies that will develop a European and international outlook in teacher education. The Academies will embrace multilingualism and cultural diversity, develop teacher education in line with the EU's priorities in education policy and contribute to the objectives of the European Education Area.
- **Erasmus Mundus Action:** This action aims at fostering excellence and world-wide internationalisation of higher education institutions via study programmes – at master course level – jointly delivered and jointly recognised by higher education institutions established in Europe, and open to institutions in other countries of the world.
- **Partnerships for Innovation, including:**
 - **Alliances for Innovation:** This action aims at fostering strategic cooperation between key players in higher education and vocational education and training, business and research – the "knowledge triangle" – to foster innovation and modernisation of education and training systems in identifying and supplying the right set of skills, knowledge and competences to match the future labour market demand in sectors and fields that are strategic for Europe's sustainable growth and competitiveness.
 - **Forward-looking Projects:** This action aims to foster innovation, creativity and participation, as well as social entrepreneurship in different fields of education and training. It will support forward-looking ideas based around key European priorities, and that have the potential of becoming mainstreamed and giving input for improving education and training systems, as well as to bring a substantial innovative effect in terms of methods and practices to all types of learning and active participation settings for Europe's social cohesion.
- **Capacity Building projects, including:**
 - **Capacity Building projects in the field of higher education:** This action supports international cooperation projects based on multilateral partnerships between organisations active in the higher education field in EU Member States or third countries associated to the programme and third countries not associated to the programme. They aim to support the

relevance, quality, modernisation and accessibility and of higher education in third countries not associated to the programme as a driver of sustainable socio-economic development. • Capacity Building projects in the field of vocational education and training: This action in the field of Vocational Education and Training supports international cooperation projects based on multilateral partnerships between organisations active in the field of VET in EU Member States, third countries associated to the programme and third countries not associated to the programme. They aim to support the relevance, accessibility, and responsiveness of VET institutions and systems in third countries not associated to the programme, as a driver of sustainable socio economic development. • Capacity Building projects in the field of youth: This action supports cooperation and exchange in the field of youth between organisations in EU Member States, third countries associated to the programme and third countries not associated to the Programme, and covers non-formal learning activities, with a focus on raising the capacity of organisations working with young people outside formal learning, while ensuring the active participation of young people. 16 • Capacity Building projects in the field of sport: The action will support international cooperation projects based on multilateral partnerships between organisations active in the field of sport in EU Member States, third countries associated to the programme and third countries not associated to the programme. They aim to support sport activities and policies in third countries not associated to the programme as a vehicle to promote values as well as an educational tool to promote the personal and social development of individuals and build more cohesive communities. Not-for-profit sport events: This action will support the preparation, organisation and follow-up of not-for-profit sport events, organised either in one single country or in several countries by not-for-profit organisations or public bodies active in the field of sport. These events will aim at increasing the visibility of the Erasmus+ sport actions as well as raise awareness on the role of sport in promoting social inclusion, equal opportunities and health-enhancing physical activities. In addition to the actions listed above, online platforms such as the European School Education Platform (including eTwinning), the Electronic Platform for Adult Learning in Europe (EPALE), and the European Youth Portal will offer virtual collaboration spaces, partner-finding databases, communities of practice and other online services for teachers, trainers, youth workers, policy makers and other practitioners, as well as for pupils, young people and adult learners in Europe and beyond.

KEY ACTION 3 – SUPPORT TO POLICY DEVELOPMENT AND COOPERATION This Key Action supports: The European Youth Together action, targeting both youth organisations at grassroots level and larger organisations and supporting partnerships across borders. Activities under this action should contribute to widening the outreach towards young people to ensure a diversity of voices and reach a diverse range of young people within and beyond youth organisations, including youth with fewer opportunities. They should involve a variety of traditional and digital channels and facilitate the development of partnerships and networks, enabling participation and access for grassroots NGOs and youth movements. In addition, this Key Action covers: • Actions aimed at preparing and supporting the implementation of the EU policy agenda on education, training, youth and sport, including sectoral agendas for higher education, vocational education and training, schools and adult learning, and in particular by facilitating the governance and functioning of the Open Methods of Coordination. • Carrying out European policy experimentations, led by high-level public authorities and involving field trials on policy measures in several countries based on sound evaluation methods. In line with the EU Youth Strategy, financial support will also be provided to the structures animating the National Working Groups designated by each national authority in the frame of the EU Youth Dialogue at national level. • Actions aimed at gathering evidence and knowledge about education, training, youth and sport systems and policies at national and European levels, with a view to facilitate reasoned

policymaking. Evidence gathering and analysis will be undertaken through EU-wide or international surveys and studies as well as thematic and country-specific expertise. • Actions which facilitate transparency and recognition of skills and qualifications, as well as the transfer of credits, to foster quality assurance, support validation of non-formal and informal learning, skills management and guidance. This area will also include the support to national and European-level bodies or networks that facilitate cross European exchanges, as well as the development of flexible learning pathways between different fields of education, training and youth and across formal, non-formal and informal learning settings. • Actions that foster policy dialogue with stakeholders within and outside the European Union through, for example, conferences, events and other activities involving policy makers, practitioners and other stakeholders in the fields of education, training, youth and sport, to raise awareness about the relevant European policy agendas and to promote Europe as an excellent study and research destination. • Cooperation with international organisations with highly recognised expertise and analytical capacity (such as the OECD and the Council of Europe) to strengthen the impact and added value of policies in the fields of education, training, youth and sport.

JEAN MONNET ACTIONS 17 The Jean Monnet Actions support:

- Jean Monnet Action in the field of Higher Education: This action supports Higher Education Institutions inside and outside Europe in promoting teaching and research on European integration and promoting policy debate and exchanges involving the academic world and policymakers on Union policy priorities. The following sub-actions are supported:
 - Jean Monnet Modules: short teaching programmes in one or more discipline of European Union studies;
 - Jean Monnet Chairs: longer teaching posts with a specialisation in European Union studies for individual university professors;
 - Jean Monnet Centres of Excellence: focal points gathering knowledge of high-level experts in various disciplines of European studies, as well as developing transnational activities and structural links with academic institutions in other countries.
- Jean Monnet Action in other fields of education and training: This action promotes knowledge on the European Union in schools and vocational education and training (VET) institutes in the EU Member States and third countries associated with the Programme. It aims to offer opportunities to education providers to develop and deliver content to learners, to teacher training providers to support teachers with methodologies and updated knowledge on European Union issues and to promote debate and exchanges between school and VET representatives and stakeholders on learning about European Union subjects. The following sub-actions are supported:
 - Teacher Training: design and offer structured training proposals on EU subjects to teachers;
 - Learning EU Initiative: to promote a better understanding in general education and vocational training (ISCED 1 – 4).
- Jean Monnet policy debate: Jean Monnet Networks in Higher Education, in line with a specific theme linked to a Commission priority, will collect, share and discuss among partners, research findings, content of courses and experiences, products (studies, articles, content of courses, etc.). Networks for other fields of education and training, exchange of good practices and experience co-teaching within a group of countries.
- Support to designated institutions: The action supports institutions pursuing an aim of European interest, providing to the Union, its Member States and its citizens with high quality services in specific priority subject areas. The main activities and outreach of these institutions involve research, including collection of data and their analysis to prepare future policies, teaching in situ and online for future staff of the international organisations and for civil servants in particular in juridical and management areas, organising events on priority issues for the Union and disseminating specific results and general information for the broad public.

WHAT IS THE BUDGET? The Programme has an overall indicative financial envelope of more than 26 billion EUR²³ of the EU Budget for the seven years (2021-2027). The annual budget is adopted by the Budgetary

Authority. The different steps for the adoption of the EU budget can be followed at: https://commission.europa.eu/strategy-and-policy/eu-budget/how-it-works/annual-lifecycle_en. For information about the available budget by action, please consult the 2026 Erasmus+ Annual Work Programme: <https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/resources-and-tools/documents-and-guidelines>

Application Process

The applicant organisation is the key actor in a Key Action 1 project. The application process for both short-term projects and Erasmus accreditations focuses on the needs and plans of the applicant organisation (or its consortium). The applicant organisation drafts and submits the application, signs the grant agreement, implements the mobility activities, and reports to the National Agency. Once the grant agreement enters into force, the applicant formally becomes the 'beneficiary' of an EU grant. Mobility activities in a mobility project can be outgoing or incoming. Most types of available activities are outgoing mobility activities. This means that the applicant organisation (the beneficiary) will act as a sending organisation: it will select participants and send them to a hosting organisation abroad. In addition, there are special types of incoming activities that allow applicant organisations to invite experts or teachers and educators in training to their organisation. The purpose of incoming activities is not to create two-way exchanges, but rather to bring in persons who can help develop and internationalise the applicant organisation. 83 Implementation of all activities supported under this Action must follow the Erasmus quality standards⁸⁷. The Erasmus quality standards cover concrete implementation practices for project tasks such as selection and preparation of participants, definition, evaluation, and recognition of learning outcomes, sharing of project results, etc. Language learning is an important part of every mobility project: beneficiary organisations should provide their participants with language learning support before and during the mobility activities. For this purpose, Erasmus+ funds the Online Language Support platform which is free and open for use by all Erasmus+ participants.

OBJECTIVES OF THE EMJM

The EMJM aims to enhance the attractiveness and excellence of European higher education in the world and attract talent to Europe, through a combination of: (i) (ii) institutional academic cooperation to showcase European excellence in higher education, and individual mobility for all students taking part in the EMJM, with EU-funded scholarships for the best students applying WHICH ARE THE CRITERIA TO BE MET TO APPLY FOR ERASMUS MUNDUS JOINT MASTERS? ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA In order to be eligible for an Erasmus grant, project proposals for Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters must comply with the following criteria:

Eligible participating organisations (Who can apply?)

In order to be eligible, the applicants (beneficiaries and affiliated entities) must:

- be legal entities (public or private bodies).
- be Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) established in one of the eligible countries, i.e. an EU Member State, third country associated to the Programme or an eligible third

country not associated to the Programme. HEIs established in an EU Member State or third country associated to the Programme must be holders of the ECHE certificate (Erasmus Charter for Higher Education). An ECHE is not required for participating HEIs from third countries not associated to the Programme, but they will have to commit to its principles. Associations or organisations of HEIs, public or private organisations (including their affiliated entities) that contribute directly and actively to the delivery of EMJM (Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters), established in an EU Member State, third country associated to the Programme or in an eligible third country not associated to the Programme, may also participate but not as coordinator. Additionally, the EMJM study programme may also benefit from the involvement of associated partners (optional). At application stage, 336 full partner HEIs must demonstrate to have fulfilled the external Quality Assurance (QA) requirements of their jurisdiction for the joint programme. This can result either (i) from having successfully implemented the European Approach for Quality Assurance of Joint Programmes (if national legislation allows), (ii) or be based on a specific accreditation/evaluation of the joint programme, (iii) or of each national component on the basis of which the EMJM is composed. Exception: organisations from Belarus (Region 2) and the Russian Federation (Region 4) are not eligible to participate in this action.

Duration of the project

Projects should normally last 74 months (extensions are possible, if duly justified and through an amendment). Previously funded Erasmus Mundus Joint Master Degrees (EMJMDs) and Joint Masters (EMJMs) can only apply for renewal at the earliest the year before the contract ends. Exception: EMJMs selected in 2021 are eligible to apply provided that their ongoing contract ends before 31 March 2028. In no circumstance can two editions of a Master funded by two different grant agreements start in the same academic year.

Geographic location (Venue of the activities)

Activities must take place in the eligible countries.

Consortium composition (Number and profile of participating organisations)

Proposals must be submitted by a consortium of at least 3 HEIs (beneficiaries; not affiliated entities) from 3 different countries, of which at least 2 different EU Member States and/or third countries associated to the Programme.

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

In order to be eligible for an Erasmus+ grant, project proposals for Erasmus Mundus Design Measures must comply with the following criteria:

Eligible participating organisations (Who can apply?)

In order to be eligible, applicants must be:

- legal entities (public or private bodies);
- higher education institutions (HEIs) established in one of the eligible countries, i.e. an EU Member State or third country associated to the Programme;
- holders of the ECHE certificate (Erasmus Charter for Higher Education).

Duration of the project

Projects should normally last 15 months (extensions are possible, if duly justified and through an amendment).

Where to apply?

To the European Education and Culture Executive Agency (EACEA). Call ID: ERASMUS-EDU-2026-EMJM-DESIGN Before applying, please see the relevant FAQs in FTOP

When to apply?

Applicants must submit their grant application by 12 February at 17:00:00 (Brussels time).

How to apply?

For information, please consult Part C of this Guide.

Required documents

All applicants must provide a declaration on honour certifying, among other things, that they have the financial capacity to implement the project. This declaration on honour constitutes a specific section of the application form. In case of EU grant requests exceeding EUR 60 000 and submitted by entities which are not exempt from undergoing the verification of their financial capacity as outlined above, in addition to the declaration on honour, the applicants must submit, but only upon request, the following documents⁴⁸⁰ through the EU Funding & Tenders Portal (Participant Register – “Financial capacity” tab) / Organisation Registration System:

- The coordinator’s profit and loss account; ⁴⁷⁷ Art 201 (5) of the EU Financial Regulation ⁴⁷⁸ For applicants for grants of up to EUR 15 000, the applicant is exempt from financial capacity verification and therefore omitting to self-declare sufficient financial capacity is not in itself a ground for rejection. Nevertheless, all applicants, regardless of the value of the grant applied for, have to submit the Declaration on Honour as it covers many other important criteria. For all applications for grants from EUR 15 001 to EUR 60 000, the financial capacity is verified on the basis of the self-declaration provided in the Declaration on Honour and no other supporting documents are needed for this purpose. Under Art 277 (8) of the EU Financial Regulation, as of the next Multiannual Financial Framework, no Declaration on Honour will be required for applications for up to EUR 15 000. ⁴⁷⁹ See Art 21(3) Erasmus+ Regulation (EU) 2021/817 and recital 35, Article 2(44) and Article 201(5) c) of the EU Financial Regulation. European grants shall not count towards the public funds for the purposes of the financial capacity verification exemption, as the adequate financial guarantee of Member State organisation has

to be provided by the Member State. 480 For up to the last three financial years. 422 - - The balance sheet; and Other documents and official verifications, if requested⁴⁸¹. For the actions managed by the Executive Agency, for more information, see “Rules for Legal Entity Validation, LEAR Appointment and Financial Capacity Assessment”: https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021_2027/common/guidance/rules-lev-lear-fca_en.pdf Where the application concerns a grant for an action for which the amount exceeds EUR 750 000, in addition to the above, an audit report produced by an approved external auditor may be requested where available, and always in cases where a statutory audit is required by Union or national law, certifying the accounts for up to the last three available financial years. If an audit report is not available and not required, the applicant shall provide a self-declaration signed by its authorised representative certifying the validity of its accounts for up to the last three available financial years⁴⁸². For entities which cannot provide the above documents because they are newly created, an estimated financial data/financial declaration or an insurance declaration stating the applicant's financial risks may replace the above documents. The coordinator must upload these documents on the EU Funding & Tenders Portal (Participant Register – “Financial capacity”-tab) / Organisation Registration System only when contacted by the EU central validation services via Participant Register or by the relevant National Agency requesting the applicant to provide the necessary supporting documents. In case of actions managed directly by the Executive Agency, this request will be sent via the messaging function of the respective system. Where an application is submitted by multiple applicants (consortium), the National Agency or the Executive Agency may, following a risk assessment, decide to check the financial capacity of only the lead applicant (coordinator). In case of doubts about the financial capacity, the National Agency or Executive Agency may request the same documents as above from any of the other participating organisations for the purposes of verification. The financial assessment is in principle valid for 18 months after the closure date of the most recent assessed accounting period. If the participant applies for another grant during this period, the financial documents will not be requested again. However, if there are justified grounds to doubt the financial capacity or, for the actions managed by the Executive Agency, if the Rules for Legal Entity Validation, LEAR Appointment and Financial Capacity Assessment⁴⁸³ change in the meantime, a new assessment may be triggered even before the end of the 18 months. Regardless of the grant amount, the National or Executive Agency can always request the applicant to provide missing information or clarify supporting documents. If, following the analysis of these documents, the National or Executive Agency conclude that the required financial capacity is weak, they may:

- require an enhanced financial responsibility regime, i.e. joint and several responsibility for all co-beneficiaries or joint and several liability of affiliated entities;
- ask the consortium to replace the coordinator/beneficiary;
- decide to give pre-financing paid in instalments;
- lower the prefinancing;
- decide to require a bank/financial institution guarantee for (one or more) pre-financing payments or;
- decide not to give pre-financing.

If the financial capacity is considered insufficient the corresponding proposal shall be rejected. 481 The granting authority may require other documents as well, for example, a tax declaration or proof of submission of the financial statements to the relevant tax office. 482 Article 199 (1) d) of the EU Financial Regulation

Indicative timeline for notification of the grant award decision and signature of the grant agreement:

In the case of Key Action 1 projects managed by the Erasmus+ National Agencies, the notification of the award decision and the signature of the grant agreement will take place, indicatively, 4 months after the submission deadline. In the case of Key Action 2 projects managed by the Erasmus+ National Agencies, the notification of the award decision and the signature of the grant agreement will take place, indicatively, 5 months after the submission deadline. In the case of Key Action 2 and Key Action 3 projects managed by the Executive Agency, the notification of the award decision will take place, indicatively, 6 months after the submission deadline and the signature of the grant agreement will take place, indicatively, 9 months from the submission deadline.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN THE APPLICATION IS APPROVED?

Grant agreement If a project is selected for an EU grant under Erasmus+, a grant agreement is signed between the National or Executive Agency and the applicant. The applicant will receive the grant agreement to be signed and returned to the National or Executive Agency; the National or Executive Agency is the last party to sign. When the grant is signed by both parties, the applicant becomes beneficiary of an EU grant and can start the project. Grant agreements may take the form of mono-beneficiary agreements, with the applicant being the single beneficiary, or multi-beneficiary agreements, where all partner organisations of the consortium become beneficiaries of the agreement. The multi-beneficiary agreement is signed by the coordinator (lead applicant) which is the only contact point for the National or Executive Agency. However, all other organisations participating in a project as co-beneficiaries sign an accession form to confer on the coordinator the responsibility of acting as coordinator. In case of actions managed by National Agencies, the accession forms are combined with the declaration on honour and a mandate for the coordinator in a single document (Accession and Declaration on Honour Form). The accession forms of each partner to the coordinator should be provided at the application stage. If these accession forms are provided at a later stage, they must be made available at the latest by the time of the grant agreement signature. *Nota bene:* Accession forms are not required for partner organisations in countries other than the country of the applicant organisation in the case of Mobility projects for Higher education students and staff, Mobility projects for learners and staff in vocational education and training, Mobility projects for pupils and staff in school education and Mobility projects for staff in adult education. However, member organisations of national consortia in the fields of higher education, VET, school and adult education are required to provide an accession form to the applicant organisation.

Grant amount The acceptance of an application does not constitute an undertaking to award funding equal to the amount requested by the applicant. The funding requested may be reduced on the basis of the specific financial rules applying to a given Action. The award of a grant in a given round of selection does not establish an entitlement for subsequent rounds. It should be noted that the grant amount foreseen by the agreement is a maximum which cannot be increased, even if the beneficiary requests a higher amount. If the National Agency is the granting authority, for actions using a unit cost-based model, the grant amount foreseen by the agreement could, if approved by the National Agency through an amendment, be increased using a

contingency reserve to cover exceptional costs, inclusion support and/or additional units following a redistribution exercise. Funds transferred by the Executive Agency or the National Agency must be identified within the account or sub-account indicated by the beneficiary for the payment of the grant.

Payment procedures Depending on the type of Action, duration of the grant agreement and the assessment of financial risk, projects supported under the Erasmus+ Programme are subject to different payment procedures. Except for the first pre-financing payment, other payments or recoveries will be made on the basis of the analysis of reports or payment requests submitted by the beneficiary (the templates of these documents will be made available in the course of the year on the websites of National Agencies or in the Funding and Tender Portal for the Executive Agency). The payment procedures applied under Erasmus+ are described below.

Pre-financing payment A pre-financing payment will be transferred to the beneficiary within 30 days of the date when the last of the two parties signs the grant agreement ("entry into force"), and where relevant, when any appropriate financial guarantees are received (see section "financial guarantee" below). Pre-financing is intended to provide the beneficiary with a float. National Agencies or the Executive Agency may decide to split the first pre-financing payment into more instalments. They may also decide to reduce the pre-financing or not pay any pre-financing at all, if the financial capacity of the beneficiary is deemed weak.

Further pre-financing payments Under some Actions, further pre-financing payments will be transferred to the beneficiary within 60 calendar days of the receipt, by the National Agency or the Executive Agency, of the further pre-financing payment requests advanced by the beneficiary, only if the further pre-financing payment request is accompanied by a pre-financing report. These further pre-financing payments may be requested when at least 70% of the previous pre-financing payment has been used up. Where the statement on the use of the previous pre-financing payment(s) shows that less than 70% of the previous pre-financing payment(s) has been used to cover costs of the action, the amount of the new pre-financing to be paid shall be reduced by the unused amounts of the previous pre-financing.

Periodic or progress/technical reports Beneficiaries may be asked to submit a periodic report accompanying the request for an interim payment. In other cases, beneficiaries can be as well requested to submit a progress report informing on the state of implementation of the project. Progress reports do not trigger a further payment. The periodic and the progress reports must be submitted by the deadline indicated in the grant agreement.

Final payment or recovery of the balance The amount of the final payment to be made to the beneficiary will be established on the basis of a final report to be submitted by the deadline indicated in the grant agreement. If a) the events generating the grant are not implemented or are implemented in a different way than planned; or b) the eligible costs actually incurred by the beneficiary are lower than those planned at application stage, or c) the quality of the realised activities/outputs is of insufficient quality, the funding may be reduced proportionally or, where applicable, the beneficiary will be required to repay any excess amounts already received as pre-financing payment. Under some Actions, the National or Executive Agency transfers 100% of the grant awarded through the pre-financings. In such cases a payment of the balance is not due. However, if - on the basis of a final report to be submitted by the beneficiary by the deadline indicated in the grant agreement - a) the events generating the grant are not implemented or are implemented in a different way than planned; or b) the eligible costs actually incurred by the beneficiary are lower than those planned at application stage, or c) the quality of the realised activities/outputs is of insufficient quality, the beneficiary will be required to repay any excess amounts already received as pre-financing payment.

Pre-financing payments (or parts of them) may be offset (without the beneficiaries' consent) against

amounts owed by a beneficiary to the granting authority — up to the amount due to that beneficiary. The final payment will be issued within 60 calendar days of the receipt of the final report.

HOW TO SUBMIT AN ERASMUS+ APPLICATION?

To submit an Erasmus+ project, applicants must follow the four steps described below. 1) Registration. Each applicant must be registered as follows: a. For actions managed by the Executive Agency, applicants, affiliated entities, and associated partners must register in the Funding & Tenders Portal and receive a Participant Identification Code (PIC)⁴⁵⁶. Organisations/groups that have already obtained a PIC through their participation in other EU programmes do not need to register again. The PIC obtained from this previous registration is valid for applying under Erasmus+; b. For actions managed by National Agencies, applicants must, if not already done, register through the Organisation Registration system for Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps⁴⁵⁷ and receive an Organisation ID (OID); 2) Check the compliance with the programme criteria for the relevant Action/field; 3) Check the financial conditions; 4) Fill in and submit the application form. CONTENT OF GRANT APPLICATIONS The content of a grant application will depend on the specificities of the call and the electronic platform used (see “Step 4: Fill in and submit the application form” below). In general, a grant application will contain the following elements, which can be requested at different stages of the application process: a) information on the legal status of the applicant, including whether it is a non-governmental organisation; ⁴⁵³ Regulation (EU, Euratom) 2024/2509 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 23 September 2024 on the financial rules applicable to the general budget of the Union (recast), OJ L, 2024/2509, 26.0.2024. The EU Financial Regulation can be found at: https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=OJ:L_202402509 ⁴⁵⁴ EU Funding and Tenders Portal: <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/home> ⁴⁵⁵ Erasmus+ National Agencies: https://erasmus-plus.ec.europa.eu/contacts/national-agencies?facets__permanent%7Cfield_eac_topics=1964 ⁴⁵⁶ PIC is mandatory information in the application form ⁴⁵⁷ Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps Organisation Registration system: https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/erasmus_esc/index/organisations/register-my-organisation ⁴¹³ b) Declaration on Honour on absence of an exclusion situation and on compliance with the eligibility and selection criteria; c) information necessary to demonstrate the applicant’s financial and operational capacity and/or supporting documents to this effect, if needed; d) description of the action or work programme and an estimated budget, if needed; and e) indication of the sources and amounts of Union funding received or applied for in respect of the same action. STEP 1: REGISTRATION For actions managed by the European Education and Culture Executive Agency To register in the Electronic Submission System of the EU Funding & Tenders Portal, the legal representative of the applicant must carry out the following steps: • Create an EU Login account (unless the person representing the applicant already has an account). New EU Login accounts can be created via the following website: <https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/cas/>; • Access the EU Funding & Tenders Portal at <https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/portal/screen/home> and register (if applicable) on behalf of the organisation/group they represent. Guidance and Frequently Asked Questions are available on the portal. The applicant needs to register only once through the European Commission's Participant Register⁴⁵⁸. After the registration is processed, the applicant will obtain a PIC. The PIC, a 9-digit unique identifier necessary for the submission of applications. It enables the applicant to fill in the application form more easily (i.e. by inserting the PIC number in the form, all the

information provided by the applicant at registration stage will be automatically displayed in the form). For actions managed by the Erasmus+ National Agencies To register in the Organisation Registration system of Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps, the legal representative of the applicant must carry out the following steps:

- Create an EU Login account (unless the applicant has an account). New EU Login accounts can be created via the following website: <https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/cas/>;
- Access the Organisation Registration system for Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps at <https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/erasmus-esc> and register (if applicable) on behalf of the organisation/group they represent. Organisations should register only once. Once the registration is processed, the organisation will obtain an Organisation ID (OID). Organisations can check their OID or change information linked to it through the Organisation Registration system for Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps. Entering the OID into the application form will automatically fill in all the information provided by the organisation at registration stage and display it in the form. Applicants must have explicit consent to use another organisation's OID in an application form. Such proof can be requested in case of disagreements and applicants may be disqualified if they are not able to present it.

458 The European Commission has an online register of the organisations participating in various EU programmes called the Participant Register. 414 Multiple registrations for an OID by the same entity and the use of multiple OIDs by the same entity may qualify as misrepresentation under the EU Financial Regulation and lead to the entity's rejection from the affected award procedures by the National Agency. As part of the registration process, applicants must upload an Identification Form, which can be downloaded from the European Commission's website⁴⁵⁹, to ORS. Three types of the identification form are available, depending on the type of applicant (natural persons, private companies or public law bodies). The identification form is subject to a privacy statement⁴⁶⁰ and to a subsequent validation by the National Agencies. In the case of applications by a consortium, the Identification Form should be provided by all members of the consortium. However, the banking details need to be provided only for the coordinator. The form must be filled in with reference to the country in which the bank is located, even if the applicant is officially registered in another country. For grants exceeding EUR 60 000, applicants may need to upload specific documents to give proof of their financial capacity. For more details, see the section "Selection Criteria" below.

STEP 2: CHECK THE COMPLIANCE WITH THE PROGRAMME CRITERIA When developing their project and before applying for EU funding, participants must verify that they and their project respect the following criteria: admissibility, eligibility, exclusion, selection, and award.

ADMISSIBILITY CRITERIA Applications must be sent no later than the deadline for submitting applications indicated in the call. The applications must be readable and accessible. Applications must be complete, containing all required parts and mandatory annexes. Only clerical errors can be corrected after the submission deadline upon request of the managing agency for duly justified cases. For actions managed by the European Education and Culture Executive Agency Applications must be submitted electronically via the EU Funding & Tenders Portal. Applications (including annexes and supporting documents) must be submitted using the forms provided in the Submission System. Proposals must be complete and contain all the requested information and all required annexes and supporting documents:

- Application Form Part A — contains administrative information about the participants (future coordinator, beneficiaries and affiliated entities) and the summarised budget for the project (to be filled in directly online);
- Application Form Part B — contains the technical description of the project (to be downloaded from the Portal Submission System, completed, and then assembled and re-uploaded); and
- Application Form Part C (to be filled in directly online, if any) containing additional project data. Applications (Part B) are limited to 40 pages for calls

for low value grants (EUR 60 000 or below), 120 pages for calls with high value grants (EUR 4 000 000), and 70 pages for all other calls. The following actions make exception to this rule: 40 pages for “Capacity Building in Higher Education” (CBHE), 40 pages for “Capacity Building in Vocational Education and Training” (CBVET), 40 pages for “Capacity Building in Higher Education and Youth (VIRT-EXCH) and 70 pages for the action Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters. Evaluators will not consider any additional pages. For actions managed by the Erasmus+ National Agencies Applications must be submitted electronically via the forms available in the Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps website⁴⁶¹. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA Eligibility criteria are used to determine whether the applicant is allowed to participate in a call for proposals and to submit a proposal for an action. To be eligible, the applicant and the project must meet all the eligibility criteria relating to the Action under which the proposal is submitted. If the project does not meet the eligibility criteria at application stage, it will be rejected without being further evaluated. Note that eligibility conditions must be fulfilled not only at grant signature, but also throughout project duration. If it appears at implementation or final report stage that these criteria have not been fulfilled or were no longer complied with, the activities carried out may be considered ineligible, and the EU grant initially awarded to the project may have to be returned to the granting authority. The specific eligibility criteria applying to each of the actions implemented through the Erasmus+ Programme Guide are described in Part B of the guide. Reasons for rejection An application can be rejected on different grounds, as detailed in this guide or a specific call document, if applicable. In general, the authorising officer responsible shall reject from an award procedure an applicant who⁴⁶²: a) is in an exclusion situation (see the Exclusion section below); b) has misrepresented the information required as a condition for participating in the procedure or has failed to supply that information⁴⁶³; c) was previously involved in the preparation of documents used in the award procedure where this entails a breach of the principle of equality of treatment, including distortion of competition, that cannot be remedied otherwise⁴⁶⁴. Furthermore, an application can be rejected on other grounds, including, but not limited to: - - - - - non-admissibility (submission after the deadline, invalid OID, incomplete application form, lack of necessary documentation...); non-compliance with the eligibility criteria of the action; application of sanctions or restrictive measures; insufficient financial capacity; insufficient operational capacity; failure to meet the award criteria; ⁴⁶¹ <https://ec.europa.eu/erasmus-applications> ⁴⁶² Article 143 of the EU Financial Regulation ⁴⁶³ For example, if an applicant claims to have a certain level of financial health or backing that is not true, such as inflating revenue figures or misrepresenting the availability of funds or falsely claims experience or expertise in a relevant field or sector to meet the eligibility criteria. ⁴⁶⁴ For example, if an applicant previously participated in drafting the call for proposals, or if the applicant employs/has other link with a person who acted as an expert evaluating its grant application and who did not declare a conflict of interest.

GLOSSARY OF TERMS

This section presents definitions of key concepts related to the Erasmus+ Programme. The glossary is divided into sections organised in alphabetical order, covering both common terms as well as specific concepts only relevant to a given sector. Common terms

Accompanying person A person who

accompanies participants (learners, staff, young people or youth workers) in a mobility activity in order to ensure their safety, provide support and assistance, as well as assist with the participant's effective learning during the mobility experience. In individual activities, an accompanying person may accompany participants with fewer opportunities or minors and young people with little experience outside their own country. In case of group activities in the field of education and training, qualified education staff must accompany the group to facilitate the learning process. Accreditation Administrative procedure to ensure that the organisations wishing to have simplified access to Erasmus+ funding under an Action comply with a set of criteria and minimum requirements. The award of an accreditation represents the first stage in a two-stage submission procedure for certain grants and does not trigger an immediate award of funding under the Erasmus+ Programme. Affiliated entity The following can be considered affiliated entities (in accordance with Article 190 of the Financial Regulation): • legal entities having a legal or capital link with beneficiaries; this link is neither limited to the action nor established for the sole purpose of its implementation; • several entities which satisfy the criteria for being awarded a grant and together form one entity which may be treated as the sole beneficiary, including where the entity is specifically established for the purpose of implementing the action. Affiliated entities must comply with the eligibility and non-exclusion criteria, and where applicable also with the selection criteria applying to applicants but they do not count toward the minimum eligibility criteria for the consortium composition (if any). Applicant A natural person or an entity with or without legal personality who has submitted an application in a grant award procedure, including any participating organisation or informal group of young people. Applicants may apply either individually or on behalf of other organisations involved in the project. In the latter case, the applicant is also defined as coordinator. For actions managed by the Executive Agency EACEA, the applicants are those entities who will become beneficiaries and affiliated entities in the Grant Agreement if their application is funded. Application deadline Final date for submission of the application to the National or Executive Agency to be considered admissible. 444 Associated partners Entities from the public or private sector that contribute to the implementation of specific project tasks/activities or support the promotion and sustainability of the project, but that for contractual management aspects are not considered to be beneficiaries, and do not receive any funding from the Programme as part of the project (they do not have the right to charge costs or claim contributions.). Basic skills Literacy, mathematics, science and technology; these skills are included in the key competences. Beneficiary A natural person or an entity with or without legal personality with whom a grant agreement has been signed. Where there are several beneficiaries (in multi-beneficiary agreements), they can also be referred to as 'co beneficiaries'. Blended mobility A mobility activity that combines physical mobility and a virtual component, facilitating collaborative online learning exchange/teamwork. Call for proposals Invitation published by or on behalf of the Commission to submit, within a given deadline, a proposal for action that corresponds to the objectives pursued and meets the required conditions. Calls for proposals are published in the Official Journal of the European Union (C series) and/or on relevant websites of the Commission, National or Executive Agency. Clerical error A minor mistake or inadvertence unintentionally made in a document that changes its meaning, such as a typographical error or the unintentional addition or omission of a word, phrase, or figure. Co-financing The principle under which part of the costs of a project supported by the EU must be borne by the beneficiary or covered through external contributions other than the EU grant. Company Legal person established under civil or commercial law, including cooperative societies, and other legal persons governed by public or private law, except those which are non-profit-making. Consortium Two or more participating organisations

teaming up to prepare, implement and follow up a project. A consortium may be national (i.e. involving organisations established in the same country) or international (involving participating organisations from different countries). Coordinator/Coordinating organisation A participating organisation applying for an Erasmus+ grant on behalf of a consortium of partner organisations. In addition to being a beneficiary itself, the coordinator has special obligations as foreseen in the grant agreement.

Digital competence Involves the confident, critical and responsible use of, and engagement with, digital technologies for learning, at work, and for participation in society. It includes information and data literacy, communication and collaboration, media literacy, digital content creation (including programming), safety (including digital well-being and competences related to cybersecurity), intellectual property related questions, problem solving and critical thinking.

Enterprise Any undertaking engaged in an economic activity, irrespective of its size, legal form or of the economic sector in which it operates.

European Qualifications Framework (EQF) A common reference framework of eight levels of qualifications, expressed as learning outcomes with increasing levels of proficiency. They serve as a translation device between different qualifications systems and their levels. The purpose of the European Qualifications Framework for lifelong learning (EQF) is to improve the transparency, comparability and portability of people's qualifications (OJ 2017/C 189/03).

ESCO (multilingual classification of European Skills, Competences, Qualifications and Occupations) Identifies and categorises skills and competences, qualifications and occupations relevant for the EU labour market and education and training, in 25 European languages. The system provides occupational profiles showing the relationships between occupations, skills, competences and qualifications. ESCO has been developed in an open IT format and can be used by anyone free of charge.

Established An organisation or body is considered as established in the location where it is subject to jurisdiction for legal and tax purposes. This is normally determined based on fulfilling certain national conditions that allow such organisation or body to be formally recognized by its national authorities. In case of an informal group of young people, the legal and tax residence of its legal representative (their 'centre of interest'⁵¹⁷) is considered as having the equivalent effects for the purposes of eligibility to an Erasmus+ grant. Secondary residences and permits will not be accepted for this purpose.

European Union Member States and third countries associated to the Programme EU and non-EU countries that have established a National Agency which participates fully in the Erasmus+ Programme. The list of EU Member States and third countries associated to the Programme is provided in Part A of this Guide, section "Who can participate in the Erasmus+ Programme?". Third countries associated to the Programme have an agreement signed with the Union pursuant to Article 19 of the Erasmus+ Regulation.

Europass The Europass online platform, an action of the European Skills Agenda, provides individuals and organisations with web-based tools and information on learning opportunities, qualifications frameworks and qualifications, guidance, skills intelligence, self-assessment tools and documentation of skills and qualifications, and connectivity with learning and employment opportunities. The Europass platform also offers tools and software to support digitally signed credentials, as announced in the Digital Education Action Plan, through the European Digital Credentials for Learning. The platform interconnects with national data sources for learning opportunities and national qualifications databases or registers.

European NGO For the purpose of this programme, these are NGOs that operate through a formally recognised structure composed of a European body/secretariat legally established for at least two years in an EU Member State or third country associated to the Programme and of national organisations/branches, in at least nine EU Member States and third countries associated to the Programme. These national organisations/branches must:

- have a proven statutory link⁵¹⁸ with the

European body/secretariat; • be active in the field of education, training or youth. A European NGO must be composed of at least nine entities (the European body/secretariat and at least eight national organisations/branches) established in nine different EU Member States and third countries associated to the Programme.

First time applicant Any participating organisation that has not previously received support as a project coordinator (applicant) under a given type of action supported by this Programme or its predecessor programme in the last seven years.

517 In case of doubt, see Article 11 of Regulation (EC) No 987/2009 for elements determining residence.

518 Defined under the term “statutory link” in this Glossary.

446 Force majeure Any situation or event that prevents organisations and individuals from fulfilling their obligations in the implementation of the project activities. This situation or event has to be unforeseeable, exceptional situation and beyond the parties’ control. The force majeure cannot be due to error or negligence of the organisations or other participants involved in the action, and proves to be inevitable in spite of exercising all due diligence.

Green skills Competences and knowledge necessary to the transition to a low-carbon economy, which can be general such as sustainable agriculture, soil protection, energy use and waste reduction, or more technical such as knowledge on renewable energy.

Green travel Travel that uses low emissions means of transport for at least half of the round trip, such as bus, train, bike, or car-pooling. Traveling by boat will be considered as green travel if combined with other low-emissions means of transport.

Hosting / receiving organisation The (main) organisation that provides learning content to participants in mobility activities by using its own resources and expertise. The hosting organisation cooperates with the sending organisation to define the expected learning outcomes and the methods that will be used to achieve them. It then executes the learning programme and conducts monitoring and mentoring during the activity.

Informal learning Learning resulting from daily activities and experiences which is not organised or structured in terms of objectives, time or learning support; it may be unintentional from the learner’s perspective.

International In the context of Erasmus+, relates to any action involving at least one EU Member State or third country associated to the Programme and at least one third country not associated to the Programme.

Job shadowing A stay at a partner organisation in another country with the aim of receiving training by following practitioners in their daily work in the receiving organisation, exchanging good practices, acquiring skills and knowledge and/or building long-term partnerships through participative observation.

Key competences The basic set of knowledge, skills and attitudes which all individuals need for personal fulfilment and development, employability, social inclusion, sustainable lifestyle, successful life in peaceful societies, health-conscious life management and active citizenship, as described in the Council Recommendation 2018/C 189/01 of 22 May 2018 on key competences for lifelong learning.

Learning mobility Moving physically to a country other than the country of residence in order to undertake study, training or non-formal or informal learning.

Learning outcomes Statements of what a participant knows, understands and is able to do on completion of a learning process, which are defined in terms of knowledge, skills and competence.

Legal entity A natural person or a legal person created and recognised as such under national law, Union law or international law which has legal personality and which may, acting in its own name, exercise rights and be subject to obligations, or an entity which does not have legal personality as referred to in point (c) of Article 200(2) of the Financial Regulation.

447 Legal Entity Appointed Representative (LEAR) For action managed by the European Education and Culture Executive Agency, parallel to the validation of an organisation in the Participant Register, its legal representative(s) must nominate a Legal Entity Appointed Representative (LEAR). The LEAR role, is key: once validated by the Commission, the LEAR will be authorised to:

- manage the legal and financial information about the organisation
- manage access rights of persons in the organisation (but not at the

project level) • appoint representatives of the organisation to electronically sign grant agreements ('Legal Signatories' - LSIGN) or financial statements ('Financial Signatories' - FSIGN) via the Funding & Tenders Portal. All the steps for the LEAR validation are clarified in the Funding & Tenders Portal.

Less experienced organisation Any participating organisation that has not received support in a given type of action supported by this Programme or its predecessor programme more than twice in the last seven years. This category includes the category of “first-time applicants”, as defined above.

Life-long learning Learning in all its forms, whether formal, non-formal or informal, taking place at all stages in life and resulting in an improvement or update in knowledge, skills, competences and attitudes or participation in society from a personal, civic, cultural, social or employment-related perspective, including the provision of counselling and guidance services; it includes early childhood education and care, general education, vocational education and training, higher education, adult education, youth work and other learning settings outside formal education and training and it typically promotes cross-sectoral cooperation and flexible learning pathways.

Newcomer organisation Any participating organisation that has not previously received support in a given type of action supported by this Programme or its predecessor programme either as a coordinator or a partner.

Micro-credential A micro-credential is a recognised proof of the learning outcomes that a learner has achieved following a short learning experience, according to transparent standards and requirements and upon assessment. The proof is contained in a certified document that lists the name of the holder, the achieved learning outcomes, the assessment method, the awarding body and, where applicable, the qualifications framework level and the credits gained. Micro-credentials are owned by the learner, are shareable, portable and may be combined into larger credentials or qualifications.

Mobility/Learning agreement An agreement between the sending and receiving organisation and the participating individuals, defining the aims and content of the mobility period in order to ensure its relevance and quality. It can also be used as a basis for recognition of the period abroad by the receiving organisation.

Month For the purpose of calculating the grants, a month is equal to 30 days.

448 MOOC (Massive Open Online Course) A type of course that is completely delivered online, is open to be accessed by anyone without cost, entry qualifications or other restrictions; participant numbers are often high. These courses can have in-person components, e.g. encouraging local participant meetings, and formal assessment, but tend to use peer review, self-assessment and automated grading. There are many variations of MOOCs, focused on specific sectors, target groups (e.g. vocational focus, teachers, etc.) or teaching methods. MOOCs funded under Erasmus+ have to be open to all and both the participation and a certificate or badge of completion are free of charge for participants. The open access requirement for educational resources applies also to MOOCs and other complete courses.

National Agency A designated body in charge of managing the implementation of the Programme at national level in a Member State or in a third country associated to the Programme. One or more National Agencies may exist in each country.

National Authority An authority in charge, at national level, of monitoring and supervising the management of the Programme in a Member State or in a third country associated to the Programme. One or more National Authorities may exist in each country.

Non-formal learning Learning which takes place through planned learning activities where some form of learning support is present, but which is not part of the formal education and training system.

Occupational profile The set of skills, competences, knowledge and qualifications that is usually relevant for a specific occupation.

OID (Organisation ID) A unique number that corresponds to an organisation. This number can be used when applying for an accreditation or grant under the Erasmus+ and European Solidarity Corps actions managed by National Agencies.

Open Access Making grant outputs, such as publishing materials freely accessible to the public without restrictions,

typically through digital platforms and repositories. Erasmus+ has an Open Access Requirement for educational resources and encourages Open Access of research results and data. Open Educational Resources (OER) Educational materials of any kind (e.g., textbooks, worksheets, lesson plans, instructional videos, entire online courses, educational games) which can be freely used, adapted and shared. OERs have either been released under an open license or are in the public domain (i.e., copyright protection has expired). Cost-free materials that cannot be adapted and shared by the public are not OERs. Open licence A way for copyright holders (creators or other rightsholders) to grant the general public the legal permission to freely use their work. Under the Erasmus+ Open Access Requirement, any such open license must permit at least use, adaptation and distribution. The open license should be indicated on the work itself or wherever the work is distributed. Educational materials with an open license are called Open Educational Resources (OERs).

Participant in Erasmus+ project Individual who is fully involved in a project and who may receive European Union funding intended to cover the costs of participation (notably travel and subsistence).

Participating organisation An organisation or informal group of young people involved in an Erasmus+ project, as either coordinator or partner.

Partner organisation In actions managed by National Agencies, an organisation formally involved in the project (co-beneficiaries) but not taking the role of coordinator.

Partnership An agreement between a group of institutions or organisations to carry out joint activities and projects.

449 Participant with fewer opportunities People with fewer opportunities means people who, for economic, social, cultural, geographical or health reasons, a migrant background, or for reasons such as disability and educational difficulties or for any other reasons, including those that can give rise to discrimination under article 21 of the Charter of Fundamental rights of the European Union, face obstacles that prevent them from having effective access to opportunities under the programme.

Peer Learning A reciprocal learning activity, which is mutually beneficial and involves the sharing of knowledge, ideas and experience between the participants. Peer learning practices enable to interact with other participants, their peers, and participate in activities where they can learn from each other and meet educational, professional and/or personal development goals.

Professional development Process of enhancing the professional capabilities of participants (learners and staff) by developing competences and expertise and acquiring new skills, which are normally identified in a development needs analysis. Professional development encompasses all types of learning opportunities, ranging from structured trainings and seminars to informal learning opportunities.

Profit-making body active in corporate social responsibility An organisation active in corporate social responsibility which integrates social, environmental, and ethical concerns into its strategies and core operations alongside its financial goals, and demonstrates substantial experience in the youth sector, provided its involvement in activities funded under this Programme does not have a commercial purpose and is not aimed at generating profit.

Project A coherent set of activities which are designed and organised in order to achieve defined objectives and results.

Qualification A formal outcome of an assessment and validation process which is obtained when a competent body determines that an individual has achieved learning outcomes to given standards.

Receiving organisation A participating organisation receiving participants and organising activities of an Erasmus+ project.

School An institution providing general, vocational or technical education, at any level from pre-school to upper secondary education, including early childhood education and care. To verify eligibility under the field of 'school education', please consult the definition of eligible schools in each country on the website of the relevant National Agency.

School pupil A person enrolled in a learning capacity at an institution providing general education at any level from early childhood education and care to upper secondary education, or a person schooled outside an institutional setting considered by

the competent authorities as eligible to participate in the Programme in their respective territories.

Sending organisation A participating organisation sending one or more participants to an activity of an Erasmus+ project.

Small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) Enterprises (see definition above) which employ fewer than 250 people and which have an annual turnover not exceeding 50 million EUR, and/or an annual balance sheet total not exceeding 43 million EUR.

450 Social enterprise An undertaking, irrespective of its legal form, which is not listed on a regulated market within the meaning of Article 4(21) of Directive 2014/65/EU, and which: 1) in accordance with its articles of association, statutes or any other statutory document establishing the business, has as its primary objective the achievement of measurable, positive social impacts rather than generating profit for its owners, members and stakeholders, where the undertaking: a) provides innovative services or goods which generate a social return and/or b) employs an innovative method of production of goods or services and that method of production embodies its social objective; 2) reinvests its profits first and foremost to achieve its primary objective and has in place predefined procedures and rules for any circumstances in which profits are distributed to shareholders and owners, in order to ensure that any distribution of profits does not undermine the primary objective; 3) is managed in an entrepreneurial, accountable and transparent way, in particular by involving workers, customers and/or stakeholders affected by its business activities.

Staff A person who, on either a professional or a voluntary basis, is involved in education, training or non-formal learning at all levels. Includes professors, teachers (including pre-school teachers), trainers, school leaders, youth workers, sport staff, early childhood education and care staff, non educational staff and other practitioners involved on a regular basis in promoting learning.

Statutory link The cooperation between the organisations concerned is based on a formalised/documented relation, which is neither limited to the project they apply for, nor established for the sole purpose of its implementation. This link can cover many forms, from a very integrated one (e.g., one "mother organisation" with its national branches/affiliated entities with or without proper legal entity) to a looser one (e.g., a network functioning through a clearly defined membership modality requiring for instance: the payment of a fee, the signature of a membership contract/agreement, the definition of rights and obligations from the two parties, etc.).

Study visit A trip where the participant gets to know and study another organisation or institution, its practices and systems. It enables the participant to have a learning experience based on direct contact and on observation of the host organisation's methods and practices.

Third countries not associated to the Programme Third countries not associated to the Programme are countries which do not have an agreement signed with the Union pursuant to Article 19 of the Erasmus+ Regulation. Pursuant to Article 20 of this Regulation, in duly justified cases in the Union's interest, the actions referred to in Articles 5 to 7, points (a) and (b) of Article 8 and Articles 9 to 14 of Erasmus+ Regulation may also be open to participation of legal entities of third countries not associated to the Programme. No National Agency is established in these countries. The list of third countries not associated to the Programme whose legal entities may apply to Erasmus+ calls is set out in Part A of this Guide in the section "Who can participate in the Erasmus+ Programme?".

Decision to award a grant to such entities is made by the authorising officer on a case-by-case basis, having regard to the justification of the Union's interest.

Traineeship (work placement) Time spent in an enterprise or organisation in another country, with a view to acquiring specific competences that are needed by the labour market, gaining work experience and acquiring more understanding of the economic and social culture of that country.

451 Transnational In the context of Erasmus+, relates, unless otherwise indicated, to any activity involving at least two EU Member States and third countries associated to the Programme.

Transversal (soft; life) skills Include the ability to think critically, be curious and creative, to

take initiative, to solve problems and work collaboratively, to be able to communicate efficiently in a multicultural and interdisciplinary environment, to be able to adapt to context and to cope with stress and uncertainty. These skills are part of the key competences.

Union transparency and recognition tools

Instruments to help stakeholders understand, appreciate and, where appropriate, recognise learning outcomes and qualifications throughout the European Union.

Validation of non-formal and informal learning A process of confirmation by an authorised body that an individual has acquired learning outcomes measured against a relevant standard and consists of the following four distinct phases: 1. Identification through dialogue of particular experiences of an individual; 2. Documentation to make visible the individual's experiences; 3. A formal assessment of these experiences; and 4. Certification of the results of the assessment which may lead to a partial or full qualification

Venue The physical location where an activity is taking place.

Virtual cooperation Any form of cooperation using information and communication technology tools to facilitate and support any relevant Programme actions.

Virtual learning Acquisition of knowledge, skills and competences through the use of information and communication technology tools that allow participants to have a meaningful transnational or international learning experience.

Work Package A component of the project work breakdown. It represents a group of project activities targeting common specific objectives.

Young people In the context of the Erasmus+ Programme, individuals aged between 13 and 30.

Higher Education Credit A set of learning outcomes of an individual which have been assessed and which can be accumulated towards a qualification or transferred to other learning programmes or qualifications.

Credit mobility A limited period of study or traineeship abroad set within on-going studies at a home institution - for the purpose of gaining credits. After the mobility phase, students return to their home institution to complete their studies.

Degree mobility A period of study abroad aimed at acquiring a full degree or certificate in the destination country/ies.

Diploma Supplement An annex to the official qualification documentation, which is designed to provide more detailed information on the studies completed according to an agreed format, which is internationally recognized; a document accompanying a higher education diploma, providing a standardised description of the nature, level, context, content and status of the studies completed by its holder. It is produced by higher education institutions according to standards agreed by the European Commission, the Council of Europe and UNESCO. In the context of an international joint study programme, it is recommended to deliver a "joint diploma supplement" covering the entire programme and endorsed by all the degree awarding universities.

452 Double degree/multiple degree (At least) two separate degree certificates awarded to a student upon successful completion of a joint programme. A double degree is a specific type of multiple degree. Each degree must be signed by the competent authority of the institution concerned, and recognised officially in the countries where the different awarding institutions are located.

ECHE (Erasmus Charter for Higher Education) An accreditation granted by the European Commission giving the possibility to higher education institutions from EU Member States and third countries associated to the Programme to be eligible to apply and participate in learning mobility and cooperation activities under Erasmus+. The award of an ECHE represents the first stage in a two-stage submission procedure for certain grants and does not trigger an immediate award of funding under the Erasmus+ Programme.

Higher Education institutions from the Western Balkans third countries not associated to the programme can apply for and be granted an ECHE for the purposes of the Call for Proposals on the European Universities, to which they are eligible. The Charter outlines the fundamental principles an institution should adhere to in organising and implementing high quality mobility and cooperation. It states the requisites the institution agrees to comply with to ensure high quality services and procedures, as well as the provision

of reliable and transparent information. ECTS (European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System) A learner-centred system for credit accumulation and transfer, based on the transparency of learning, teaching and assessment processes. Its objective is to facilitate planning, delivery and evaluation of study programmes and learner mobility through the recognition of qualifications and periods of learning. A system that helps to design, describe and deliver study programmes and award higher education qualifications. The use of ECTS, in conjunction with outcomes-based qualifications frameworks, makes study programmes and qualifications more transparent and facilitates the recognition of qualifications. Higher education institution Means an institution which, in accordance with national law or practice, offers recognised degrees or other recognised tertiary level qualifications, regardless of what such an establishment is called, or a comparable institution at tertiary level which is considered by the national authorities as eligible to participate in the Programme in their respective territories. Joint degree Single degree certificate awarded to a student upon successful completion of a joint programme. The joint degree must be signed by the competent authorities of two or more of the participating institutions jointly and recognised officially in the countries where those participating institutions are located. Joint programmes Higher education (study or research) programmes jointly designed, delivered and fully recognised by two or more higher education institutions. Joint programmes can be implemented at any higher education cycle, i.e., bachelor, master or doctorate or even short cycle. Joint programmes can be national (i.e., when all universities involved are from the same country) or transnational/international (i.e. when at least two different countries are represented among the higher education institutions involved). 453 One-cycle study programmes Integrated/long programmes leading either to a first or a second-cycle degree and which, in some countries, can still be better characterised by duration in years rather than credits. In most of these countries, the programmes outside the Bologna first-cycle model are in the fields of medicine, dentistry, veterinary medicine, nursing and midwifery and in most cases involve 1-8 % of the student population. The typical length of integrated programmes leading to regulated professions is in general 300 360 ECTS/five-six years depending on the regulated profession in question. Third cycle The third cycle level in the Qualifications Framework for the European Higher Education Area agreed by the ministers responsible for higher education at their meeting in Bergen in May 2005 in the framework of the Bologna process. The descriptor of the third cycle of the QF EHEA corresponds to the learning outcomes for EQF level 8. Vocational Education and Training 519 Apprenticeship (Apprentice) 520 Without prejudice to national terminology, apprenticeships are understood as formal vocational education and training schemes that: a) combine learning in education or training institutions with substantial work-based learning in companies and other workplaces, b) lead to nationally recognised qualifications, c) are based on an agreement defining the rights and obligations of the apprentice, the employer and, where appropriate, the vocational education and training institution, and d) include payment or other compensation to the apprentice for the work-based component. EQAVET (European Quality Assurance Reference Framework for Vocational Education and Training) A reference tool for policy-makers based on a four-stage quality cycle that includes goal setting and planning, implementation, evaluation and review. It respects the autonomy of national governments and is a voluntary system to be used by public authorities and other bodies involved in quality assurance. VET skills competitions International sectoral events in which competitive demonstration of skills by VET learners is central for promotion, recognition and exchange of experience, know-how and technological innovations in VET. The events are a result of close cooperation between businesses, VET providers, chambers of commerce and other relevant stakeholders that aim at improving attractiveness and excellence in VET, creating global training

standards and benchmarking systems, and influencing industry, government, and educators through cooperation and research. The purpose of skills competitions is to raise the profile and recognition of skilled people and show how important skills are in achieving economic growth and personal success. They are designed to inspire young people to develop a passion for skills and pursuing excellence, through competitions and promotions. 519 For other VET terminology please use the official Cedefop publication: https://www.cedefop.europa.eu/files/4117_en.pdf 520 <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32018H0502%2801%29> Vocational education and training (VET) Vocational education and training (VET) learner Education and training which aims to equip young people and adults with knowledge, skills and competences required in particular occupations or more broadly on the labour market. It may be provided in formal and in non formal settings, at all levels of the European Qualifications Framework (EQF), including tertiary level, if applicable. For the purpose of Erasmus+, projects focusing on initial or continuing vocational education and training are eligible under VET actions. A person enrolled in an initial or continuous vocational education and training programme or a person who has recently graduated or obtained a qualification from such a programme. Work-based learning Acquisition of knowledge and skills through carrying out – and reflecting on – tasks in a vocational context, either at the workplace (such as alternance training) or in a vocational education and training institution. Adult education Adult education Adult learner All forms of non-vocational adult education, whether of a formal, non formal or informal nature (for continuous vocational training see "VET"). Any adult who, having completed or being no longer involved in initial education or training, returns to some forms of non-vocational continuing learning (formal, non-formal or informal). Youth Coach Community building Dialogue mechanisms Digital Youth Work Facilitator Group Leader A resource person who is not a member of the group and who supports young people in the preparation, implementation and evaluation of their project. Creation or enhancement of a community among individuals who share a common need or interest or who lived a joint experience which created common ground. The community created through the community building process is a lively group of members who exchange practices and ideas for further development to the benefit of the community itself. Dialogue with young people and youth organisations and decision makers which serves as a forum for continuous joint reflection on the priorities, implementation and follow-up of European cooperation in the youth field. Proactively using or addressing digital media and technology in youth work. Digital media and technology can be either a tool, an activity or a content in youth work. Digital youth work is not a youth work method, it can be included in any youth work setting and it has the same goals as youth work in general. A person who helps a group of (young) people to work together better, understand their common objectives, and plan how to achieve these objectives through Erasmus+ activities In youth mobility projects, an adult of at least 18 years of age who joins the young people participating in a Youth Exchange in order to ensure their effective learning (Youthpass), protection and safety. 454 455 Informal group of young people A group of at least four young people (13-30 years old) which does not have legal personality under the applicable national law, provided that their group representative has the legal capacity to undertake legal obligations on their behalf. In case of a group which has minors, one of the members of the group who is at least 18-years old assumes the role of representative and takes responsibility on behalf of the group. The group needs to be registered and validated in the Organisation Registration System (ORS)521. For registration purposes, the formation of the group needs to be evidenced by a registration form signed between the group members. The signatures on the registration form may have to be officially authenticated, if required by the granting authority, to ensure legal certainty. Existing groups which are already registered in ORS also need to

upload the signed registration form in their ORS profile to be eligible to apply as an informal group of young people for actions under the Call 2026 and onwards. The form can be downloaded from the Organisation Registration System (ORS) as “Informal Group of Young People – Registration Form”. The informal groups of young people can be applicants and partners in some actions of Erasmus+. For the purpose of simplification, they are assimilated to legal persons (organisations, institutions, etc.) in this Guide and fit within the notion of Erasmus+ participating organisations for Key Action 1 actions in which they can take part.

Itinerant activity An activity taking place in more than one country. Itinerant activities imply the movement of all participants at the same time.

Local participant in youth activities A participant in a learning mobility activity travelling less than 10 km to the venue of the activity. Such participants are not eligible for travel support, but, depending on the action, may be eligible for Individual Support, Organisational support and/or Inclusion support.

Smart Youth Work The innovative development of youth work encompassing digital youth work practice and including a research, quality and policy component.

Youth activity An out-of-school activity (such as a youth exchange, volunteering or youth training) carried out by a young person, either individually or in a group, in particular through youth organisations, and characterised by a non-formal learning approach.

Youth worker A professional or a volunteer involved in non-formal learning who supports young people in their personal socio-educational, and professional development.

Youthpass The European tool to improve the recognition of the learning outcomes of young people and youth workers from their participation in projects supported by the Erasmus+ Programme. Youthpass consists of:

- certificates that can be obtained by participants in several Actions of the Programme; and
- a defined process which supports young people, youth workers and youth organisations to reflect about the learning outcomes from an Erasmus+ project in the field of youth and non-formal learning.

Youthpass is also part of a broader European Commission strategy which aims to enhance the recognition of non-formal and informal learning and of youth work in Europe and beyond.

Sport 521 <https://webgate.ec.europa.eu/erasmus-esc>

Grassroots sport Sport staff Physical leisure activities practised regularly at non-professional level by people of all ages for health, educational or social purposes. A person involved in the instruction, training and management of a sports team or individual sports people, either on a paid basis or on a voluntary basis.